

Voices and moods

SENTENCES IN ENGLISH CAN BE EXPRESSED IN DIFFERENT VOICES AND DIFFERENT MOODS.

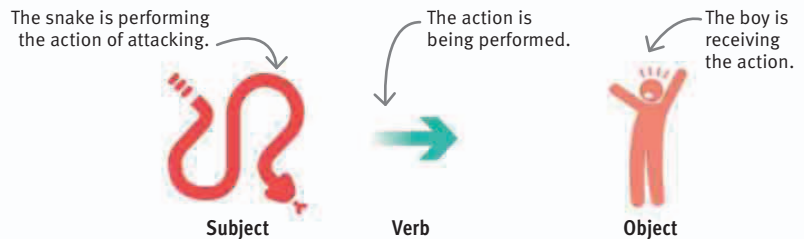
There are two voices in English. These determine whether the subject of a sentence is performing or receiving an action. Mood is the form of the verb that conveys the attitude in which a thought is expressed.

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The active voice

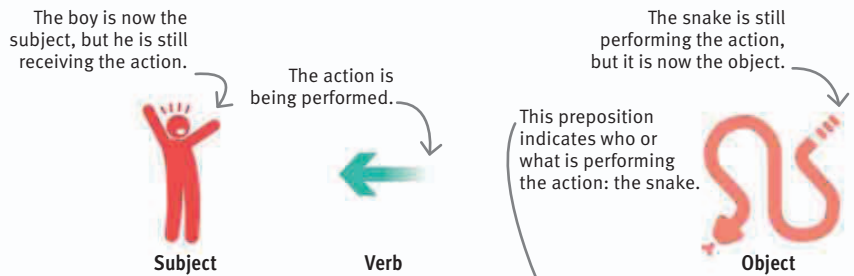
Verbs can be used in two different ways. These are known as voices. The active voice is simpler than the passive voice. In an active sentence, the subject is performing the action of the verb, and the object is receiving it.



The **snake** attacked the **boy**.

The passive voice

In a passive sentence, the word order is reversed so that the subject is receiving the action and the object is performing it. The passive voice is formed using the auxiliary verb *be* followed by a past participle. The performer of the action is either identified using the preposition *by* or not included at all.

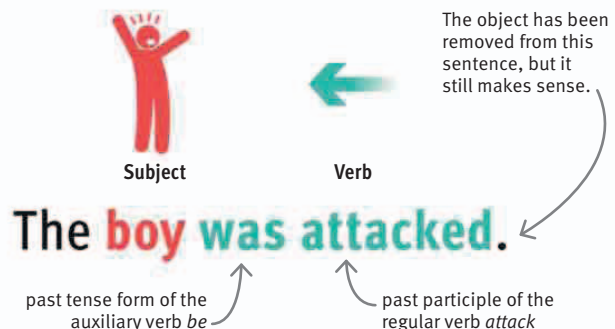


The **boy** was attacked by the **snake**.

REAL WORLD

Passive persuasion

The passive voice is often used on official signs, because it is perceived as less confrontational than the active voice. In these situations, it is also often unnecessary to state who is performing the action.



The **boy** was attacked.

past tense form of the auxiliary verb *be*

past participle of the regular verb *attack*